



Human-Computer Interaction / INFO162

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1.0 Introduction

In this semester assignment we focus on the Nightli app, evaluating its usability, accessibility, and overall user experience. The project includes an in-depth competitor analysis, examining competitors like Untappd, Google Maps, Eventbrite, and Yelp to understand strengths and weaknesses in similar applications.

The evaluation process involves both expert analysis and user testing. Through this, we aim to identify potential usability issues and gather valuable feedback to refine the app's design. Key aspects such as learnability, accessibility, and general usability will be examined during user testing by both experts and non-experts.

Additionally, the design process and development of prototypes will play a central role in addressing the identified issues. This report will outline the progress from evaluation to re-design, detailing improvements to features like the login screen and user interface components, while ensuring a user-centred approach throughout.

2.0 Domain - Nightli app

Nightli is an event discovery and nightlife planning app designed to help users find the best parties, events, and social gatherings in their area. The app provides clear and relevant lists of nightlife spots, such as clubs, bars, concerts, and festivals, offering users recommendations based on location, time, and preferences for their target group which is mostly students and people in this age group. Nightli focuses on enhancing the social nightlife experience by integrating features like guest lists, ticketing, venue information, and social sharing options. (Nightli app, 2024).

Figure 1

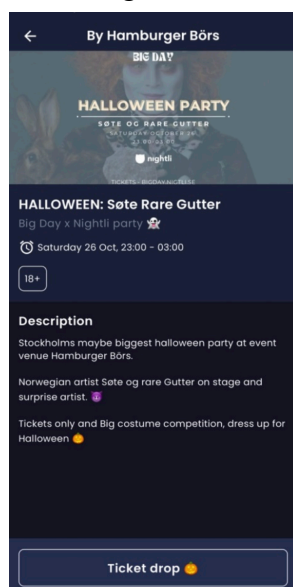
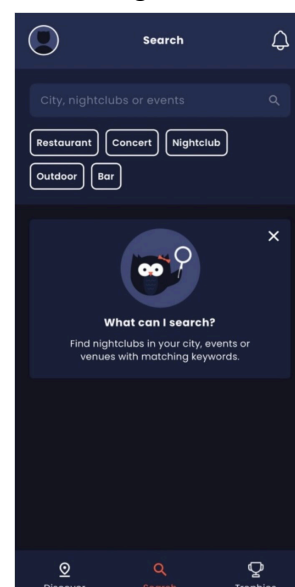


Figure 2



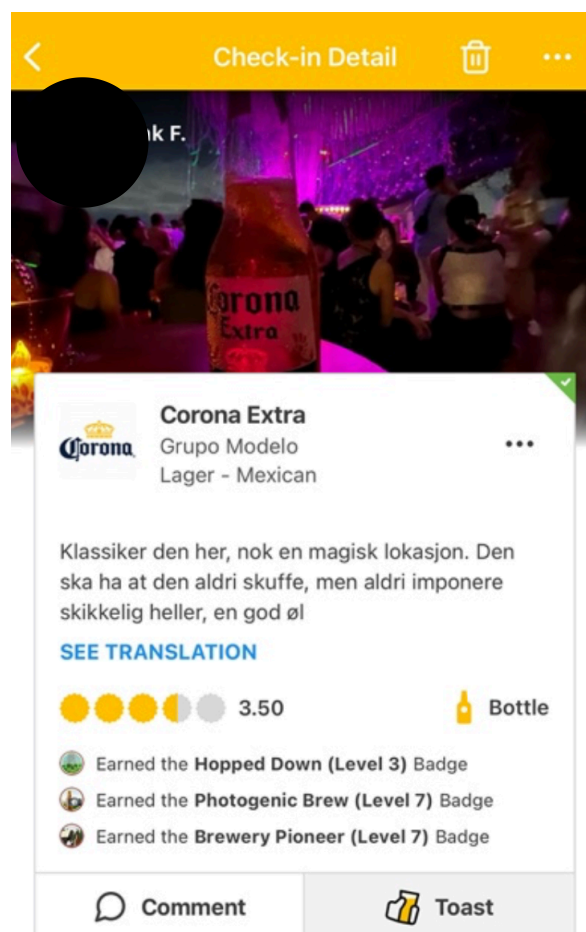
3.0 Competitor analysis

For the competitive analysis, we have chosen four main competitors in the nightlife and event discovery space, which is Untappd, Google Maps, Eventbrite, and Yelp. Each of these apps offers a distinct approach to discovering events, with different features and user experiences.

3.1 Untappd

Untappd is essentially Instagram for beers. It is a widely known international app where the user registers and “check-in” beers, either at home or at pubs and nightclubs. You can interact with your friends by getting their posts on your feed. The app is free to use, but there is a premium plan called “Insider” which grants you access to more customizable features, and less ads. The subscription costs 579 kr / year or 65 kr / month. The app also has a store where you can order beer and other beer accessories, but now it is only available for the US and Netherlands. (Untappd, 2024).

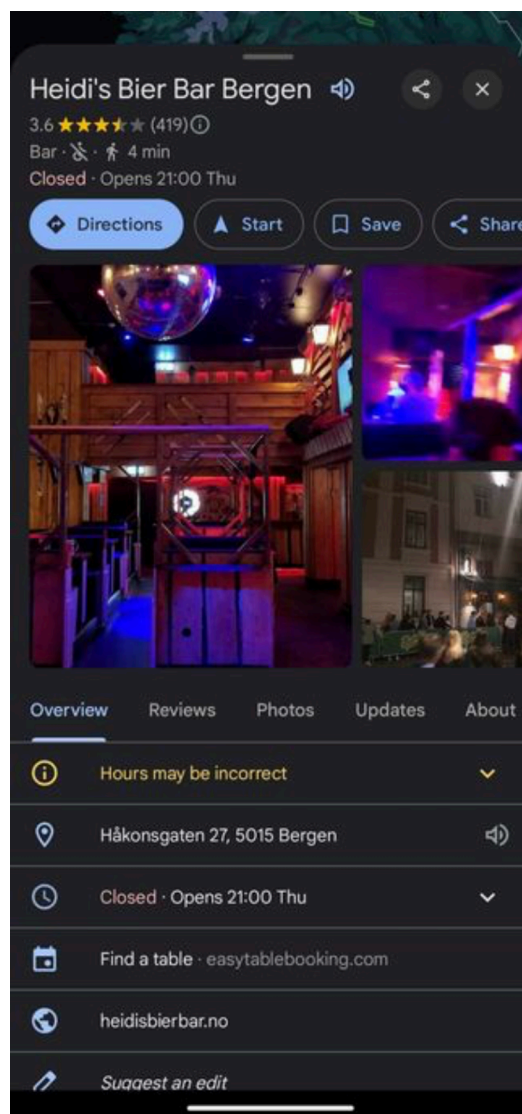
Figure 3



3.2 Google Maps

Google Maps is by far the most developed app when it comes to mapping. However, there are some functionalities that we think maps is lacking which could be tweaked for finding the best deals on nightlife. Maps have an ok user experience but can sometimes be clucky to use. Let's say you search for bars, then maps will sometimes show you the closest bars, sometimes the best rated. We want our product to be consistent and easy to sort by. Maps has a decent community which updates with photos and prices a few times a year. The more popular a bar/nightclub is, the more photos it usually has. This can be a bit frustrating when the small places don't have that many pictures. Maps does not have a premium plan and is free to use. (Google Maps, 2024).

Figure 4



3.3 Eventbrite

Eventbrite is a well-known platform that allows users to find, create, and promote events. It provides to a wide range of events, from nightlife and concerts to business conferences and workshops. It works in the way that you browse events by location, date and categories like music, shows or festivals. They also promote their own events. You can buy tickets and do event check in through the mobile app or on their website. They don't have any extra cost or premium plan other than ticket purchasing. They also offer calendar integration which means you can get the upcoming events right in your digital calendar. Things Eventbrite can improve their approach lacks the specific curation and social focus of Nightli. They also lack the social features like sharing guest lists or connecting with friends that attend the same event. (Eventbrite, 2024).

Figure 5

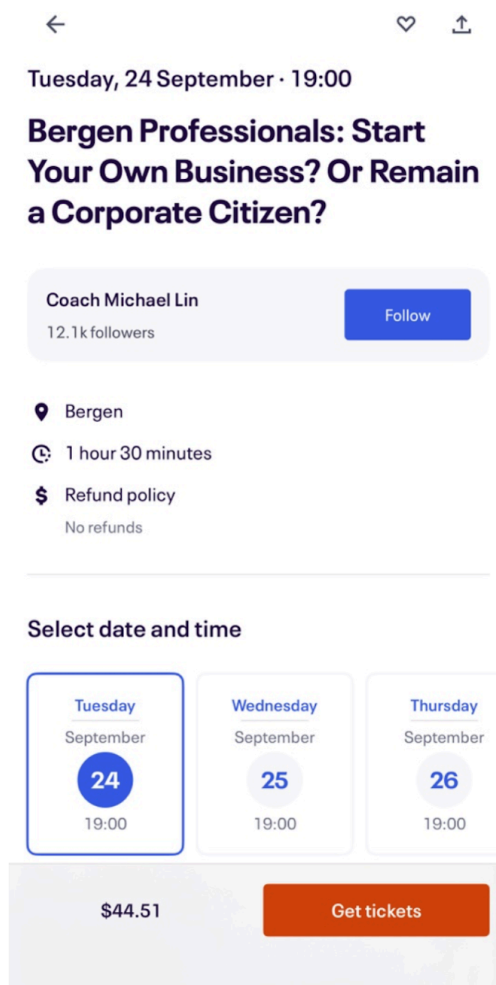
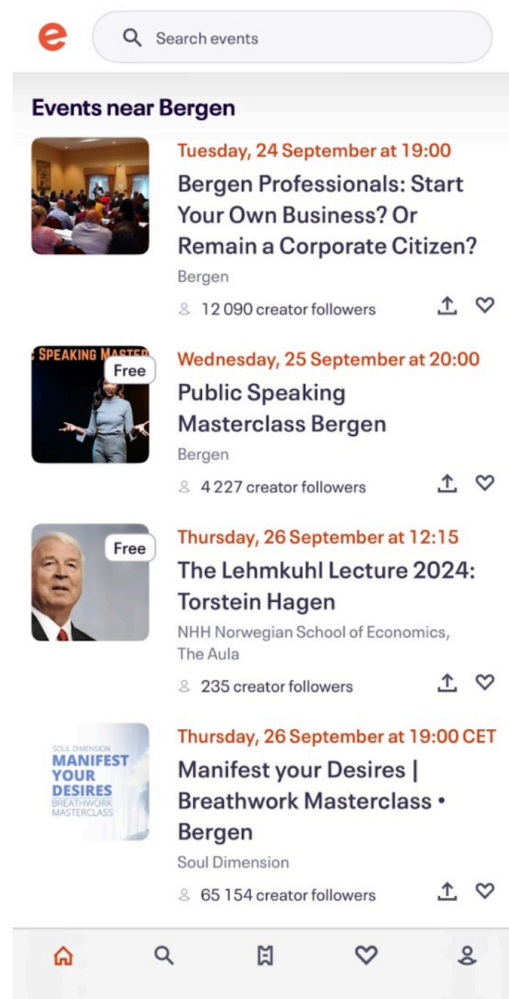


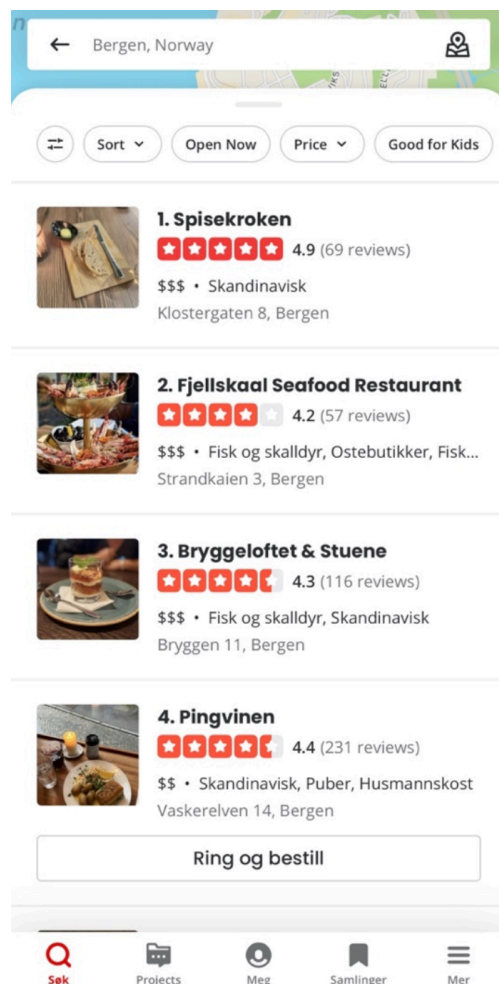
Figure 6



3.4 Yelp

Yelp is a local business discovery platform known for its extensive database of reviews, ratings, and recommendations for various types of businesses, including nightlife spots like bars, clubs, and restaurants. With Yelp you can search after businesses by location and category, read review of the locations and other business information like hours of opening, menus, and special deals. The app also has a mobile app integration with GPS for nearby Discoveries. (Yelp, 2024). Downsides of Yelp is it gives more insight in discovery of venues rather than specific events or parties, which is less helpful for users looking for good events. They don't offer integrated ticketing, the ability to join guest lists, let friends know you are attending or premium plans which are crucial parts that their competitor Nightli has succeeded with. The interface of the app is also dull in comparison to Nightli and Eventbrite which is not good when you want to cater to a younger audience.

Figure 7



Feature	Nightli	Untappd	Google Maps	Eventbrite	Yelp
Primary Focus	Nightlife, event discovery	Beer check-ins, social interaction	Mapping, local business discovery	Event discovery, ticketing	Business reviews, venue discovery
Social Features	Guest lists, social sharing	Friend interaction, check-ins, feed	User reviews, photos	Limited social features	User reviews, ratings, limited social sharing
Ticketing	Integrated	No	No	Yes	No
Platform Availability	Web, mobile (iOS/Android)	Web, mobile (iOS/Android)	Web, mobile (iOS/Android)	Web, mobile (iOS/Android)	Web, mobile (iOS/Android)
User-Friendliness	High, nightlife-focused	High, easy for beer enthusiasts	Moderate, cluttered UX for bars	High, clean interface	High, information-heavy
Event Variety	Nightlife, concerts	No events, focused on drinks	Wide variety, limited event curation	All types of events	Venue-focused, limited event specificity
Learnability	Easy	Easy	Moderate	Easy	Easy
Aesthetics	Clean, nightlife-themed	Simple, feed-based	Functional, map-heavy	Minimalistic, business-like	Information-dense, cluttered
Additional Features	Social sharing, recommendations, curated lists	Premium plan (Insider), beer store (limited regions)	Maps, local business info, photos	Event promotion, calendar integration	Reviews, photos, deals
Pricing	Free	Free, with premium plan (65 kr/month or 579 kr/year)	Free	Free	Free

The table showcases the difference between Nightli and other competitors and gives a clear view of the other apps in the nightlife space. It compares their features, strengths, and what makes them different. By looking at things like how they help users find events, how easy they are to use, and who they're designed for, we can see areas where Nightli can do better. The table also shows us what the competition might be missing, which gives Nightli a chance to stand out as a better option for students and young adults. This helps Nightli to shape themselves to be unique and useful for users.

4.0 Evaluation

We will utilize two evaluation methods:

Expert evaluation: Conducted by group members who will perform a usability test with assigned tasks within the app. This method allows for identifying usability issues based on hands-on experience and will provide a clear understanding of how well the app supports users in completing specific tasks.

User testing: Involving real users to perform tasks within the app. This method provides direct feedback on user experience, allowing us to understand how actual users interact with the app and identify areas for improvement.

4.1 Expert evaluation protocol

Participants: 3 group members will act as evaluators.

Method: Each evaluator will receive a set of specific tasks to complete within the app, such as searching for nearby nightlife events, reading and submitting reviews for a bar and saving an event to a personal calendar.

Duration: Each evaluator will have 5 minutes to complete the tasks, followed by a 10-minute group discussion to share observations and insights.

Feedback Session: After completing the tasks, we will discuss common issues and prioritize them for potential improvements.

5.0 Evaluation Process

5.1 Expert Evaluation

- Each evaluator assessed the app independently, focusing on usability heuristics.
- The group discussion afterward highlighted common issues, such as navigation difficulties and inconsistent information presentation.

5.2 User Testing

- Users completed tasks while thinking aloud, providing insights into their thought processes.
- Follow-up interviews revealed user preferences and frustrations with specific features.

5.3 Expert evaluation findings

Common issues identified:

- Confusing navigation structure, particularly in finding event listings.
- Lack of feedback after user interactions.
- Inconsistent design elements across different sections of the app.
- Lack of information about pricing of drinks on the different locations.

5.4 Expert testing feedback

Expert 1: Found it easy to navigate, but thinks that the map on the discovery is a little hard to use. Did not find any events nearby since the app only has events in Sweden. He did get to leave a review on an event, by reviewing pricing, clothing code, atmosphere and celebrity spotting which he thought was a good addition.

Expert 2: Liked the app's design, but was disappointed with the lack of drink menus. The review system gives an opportunity for a sleek and nice design with sliders, but frustrating that you can't write your own words in the review when the only option they have is sliders. For example clothing from “casual” to “well dressed”.

Expert 3: Enjoyed the app's overall look but usability could be better. He was also frustrated with the loading times for event details. Missing a feature for being able to have the app in the users native language (Only in english for now).

5.4.1 Usability

The expert evaluation and user testing highlighted significant usability issues, particularly with navigation and feedback mechanisms. Addressing these issues could enhance the user journey throughout the app.

5.4.2 Accessibility

Feedback regarding font size suggests the need for improved readability, particularly for users with visual impairments. Implementing adjustable text sizes could increase accessibility.

5.4.3 Learnability

The user testing indicated that the app has a learning curve, particularly for new users. Simplifying the onboarding process and providing guided tours could help improve initial interactions.

5.5 User testing by non-experts

Participants: We aim to recruit 3 potential users familiar with nightlife apps.

Method:

- A think-aloud protocol where users complete specific tasks while verbalizing their thoughts.
- Follow-up interviews to gather qualitative feedback.

User tasks:

- Search for nearby events.
- Read reviews for a selected bar.
- Save an event to their calendar.

Duration: Each session will last approximately 10 minutes (5 minutes for tasks and 5 minutes for interviews).

User participants: We recruited potential users through personal networks. After several outreach attempts, we successfully engaged 3 users who expressed interest in nightlife experiences.

5.6 Result of user testing feedback

User 1 - 20 year old journalism student, likes to go to concerts and nightclubs.

“ The layout looks clean, which I like. I can see the main features right away. I like how quickly I can find events. The filter options are handy. I appreciate that the reviews are easy to find, but I miss more pictures of the locations and venues. Saving to my calendar was easy, but I wish it had the option to set reminders in the app.”

User 2 - 26 year old computer science student, likes bar events like quizzes and karaoke.

“ The app feels relatable for young adults and I get curious about the different events it may offer. The search function is nice, but I’d love more categories to specify my search further. The reviews are helpful. I do wish that there were more detailed options, like ratings for crowds and price listings. Saving an event was easy, but it could use an integration with my other calendar for better organization and control.”

User 3 - 23 year old law student who likes to go out alot to venues and events.

“ I like the discovery side of the app. It's nice. Finding affordable events was simple. I love that it is a budget filter so I don't have to go through events that are way too expensive for me on the budget. The reviews are short but useful. I’d like to see more comments from students like myself. Saving events was easy. I just wish it had a way to share events directly with friends.”

5.7 Conclusion from the user testing

The user testing of the Nightli app revealed a generally positive experience among the participants. They each appreciated the app’s clean layout and navigation, which facilitated the discovery of events. Key strengths to mention some was the ease of searching for events

and the straightforward process for saving them to calendars. The areas of improvements that were mentioned was the desire for more detailed reviews, especially regarding specific aspects like crowd demographics and list pricing. Enhanced filtering options for event searches and better integration with other calendar applications were also suggested.

6.0 Identified issues with Nightli

The app is restricted to nightlife venues in Sweden, excluding users from nearby countries like Norway. This significantly limits its appeal and usability for a broader audience. Similar apps often face challenges in scaling geographically, as expanding to new regions requires working together with other clubs or companies for localised content, which can be time – demanding and resource intensive.

Not including beer and shot pricing in the app negatively impacts bars and nightclubs by reducing transparency and making it harder for customers to plan their night. It can deter budget-conscious users, who may opt for bars and nightclubs with more transparent pricing. Additionally, it limits the bars and clubs' ability to promote special deals or attract customers looking for affordable drink options. This could result in lower foot traffic and missed revenue opportunities.

Nightli doesn't clarify whether being on the guestlist exempts users from entrance fees or provides details on age restrictions. This could lead to confusion and failed expectations, a common issue in apps that aim to streamline event entry but fail to communicate terms clearly.

The absence of a desktop or web version restricts access to users who prefer non-mobile platforms. This limitation is significant as other apps in the nightlife or event management domain. Like Eventbrite that offers multi-platform access for convenience and broader reach.

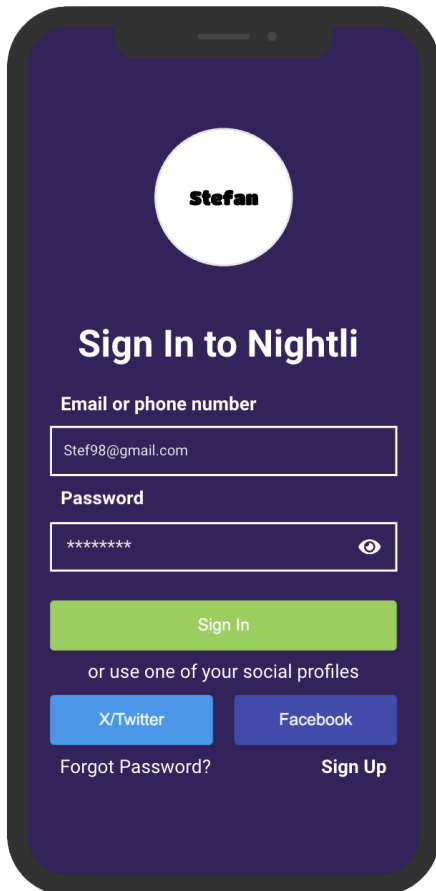
7.0 Description of the design process

Our design process was structured and collaborative, ensuring that each team member could contribute efficiently to the development of the prototype. The way we did that was with these steps: discovering requirements, designing alternatives, prototyping and evaluating. (Preece, Rogers and Sharp, p.52). First, we began discussing the core functionalities and goals of the Nightli app. This stage focused on identifying the primary user needs, such as finding nightlife events, using the guestlist, and product pricing. Then two of the team members responsible for designing the initial prototype. This included creating wireframes and mockups for the user interface, making sure that the app's navigation and key features were clearly represented. Lastly, after the prototypes were developed, it was shared with the last group member for review. Here we came with new ideas and design flaws and discussed which to keep and which to let go. Our three focus areas were user experience, visual design and feature functionality. This was to get an app that was easy to navigate, had a good layout with color scheme in and overall aesthetic appeal so when we implemented new features, such as product pricing this would look good, and the app would be pleasant to use and look at. When we had completed our prototyping, we evaluated the designs by giving each other feedback, and getting feedback from a presentation we did. We then made further improvements and ended up with the prototypes in this text.

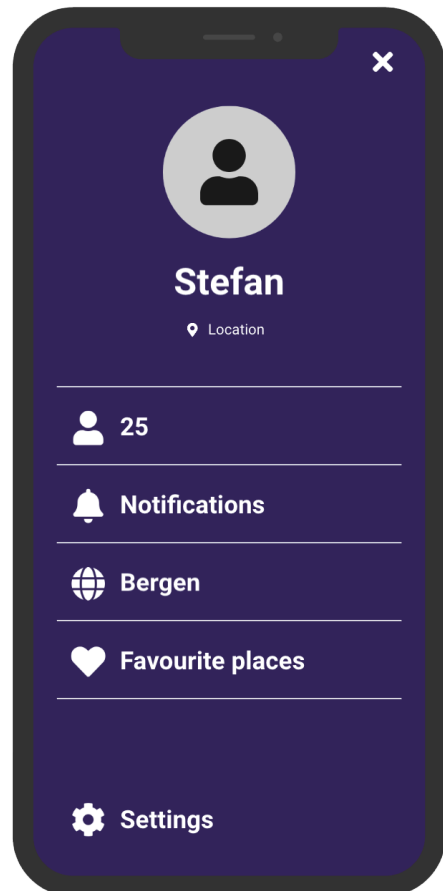
8.0 Prototypes

8.1 Login screen and “my page”

Prototype 1



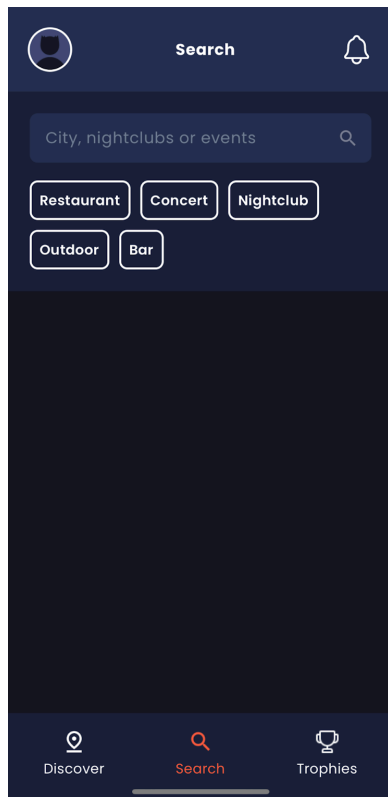
Prototype 2



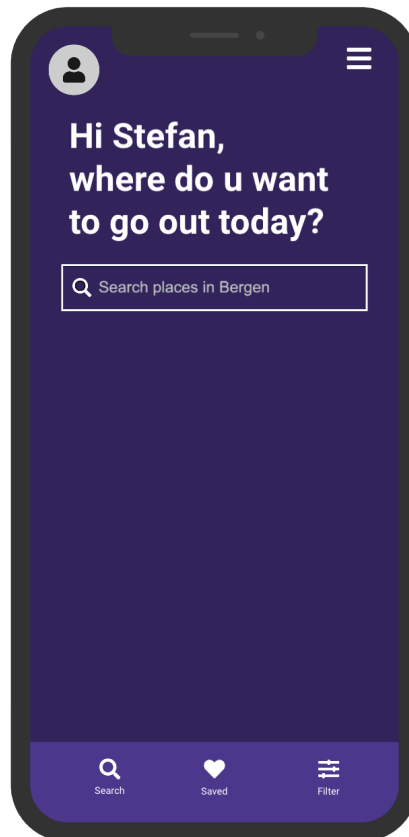
Prototype 1 is a prototype of the login screen on the app. In the original app the only option for login was with a phone number. We have added the options to login with phone number, email, X or Facebook for easier registration. Prototype 2 is a prototype of a “my page” screen. The way you navigate to this is by clicking on your profile in the top left corner as illustrated on the next prototype figures. My page didn't exist in the original app, so we thought this would be a nice addition to the app to help with easy access to configure the app.

8.2 Search page

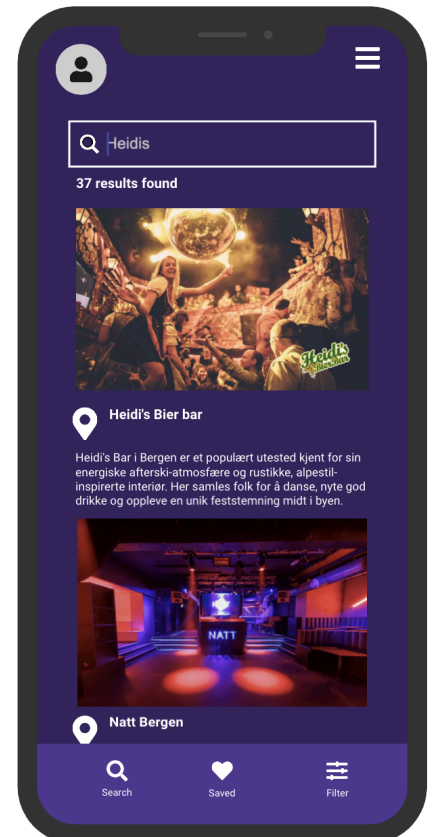
Figure 8



Prototype 3



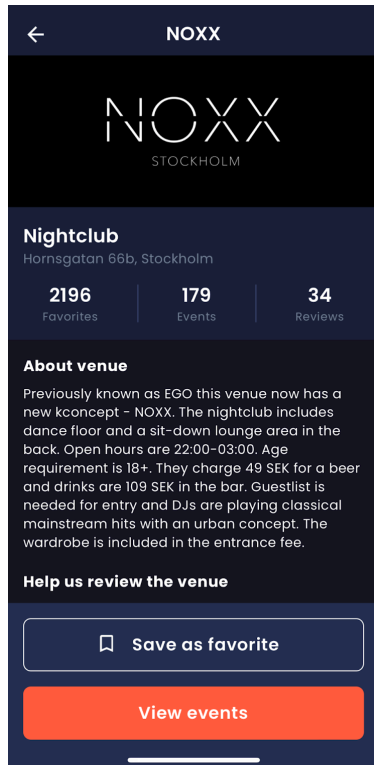
Prototype 4



The difference between Figure 8 and Prototypes 3 and 4 is quite striking. In the original search page, the darker colors and less intuitive design made it difficult to navigate, especially for intoxicated users. Additionally, we've made the search page more personalized by prompting users with a question about where they want to go out.

8.3 Detail card and reviews

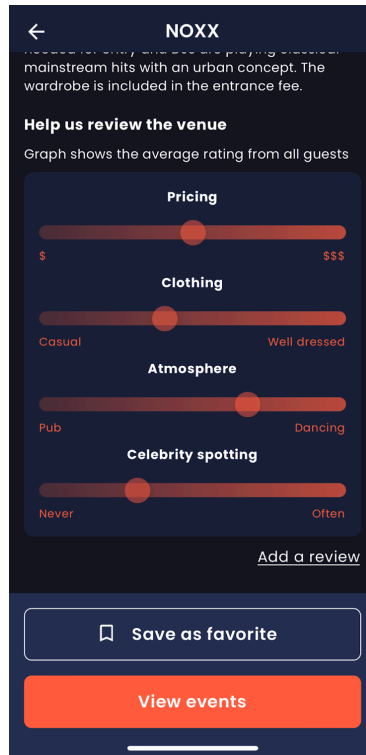
Figure 9



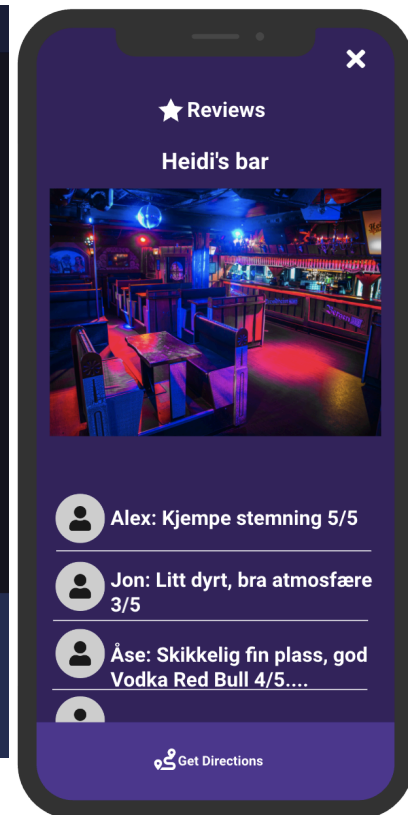
Prototype 5



Figure 10



Prototype 6

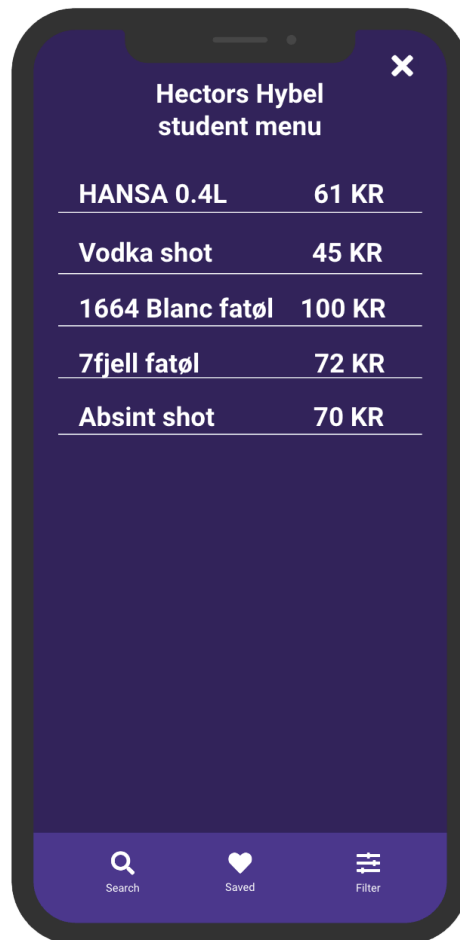


Figures 9 and 10 are screenshots from the Nightli app. The updated layout emphasises key information about the venue, ensuring users can easily access details that matter most. We've also introduced dedicated tabs for directions and reviews, providing a more streamlined and user-friendly experience. This redesign enhances usability by focusing on practical features that help users make informed decisions quickly and efficiently.

Prototype 5 and 6 showcase the revamped review system. Based on feedback, we found that the original system felt clunky, and the lack of text made it difficult for users to get an accurate sense of the venue's atmosphere. While we appreciated the use of slides, we opted to simplify the design for a more streamlined and user-friendly experience.

8.4 Menus

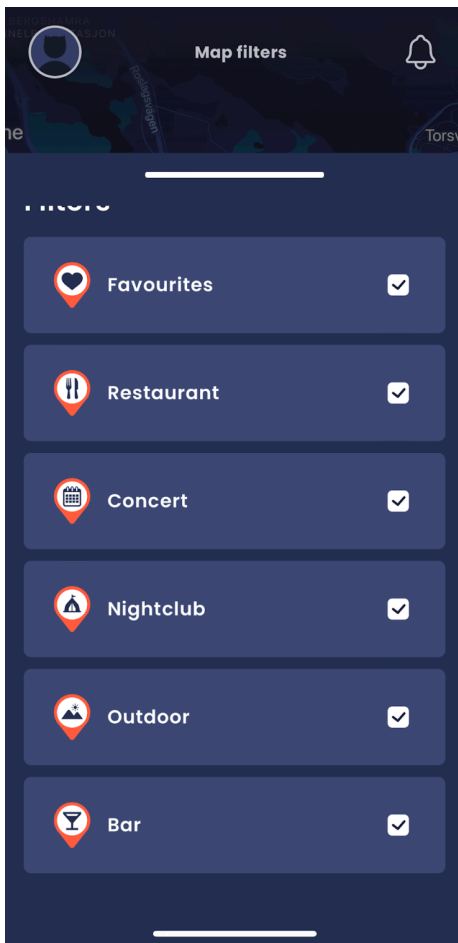
Prototype 7



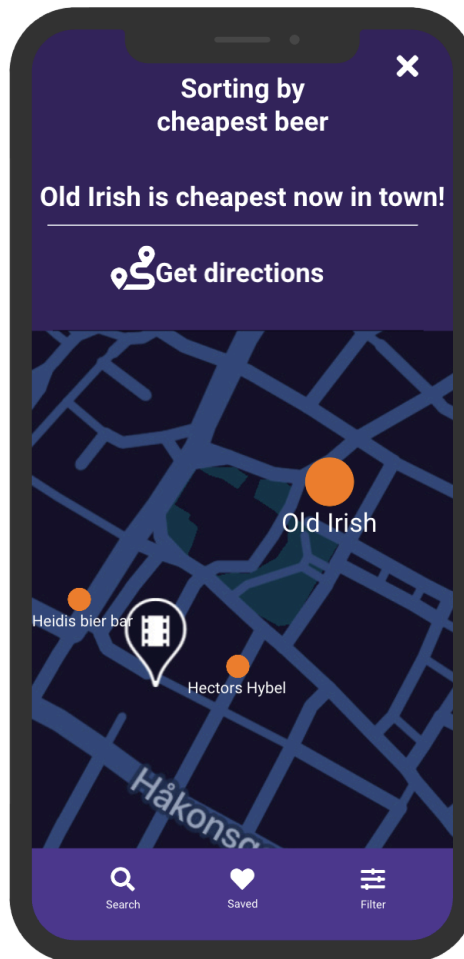
Menus for bars and nightclubs were non-existent, so we made a prototype for this. The purpose behind this was to get easier access to prices, to further improve the customers experience to pick which places they want to go to.

8.5 Map

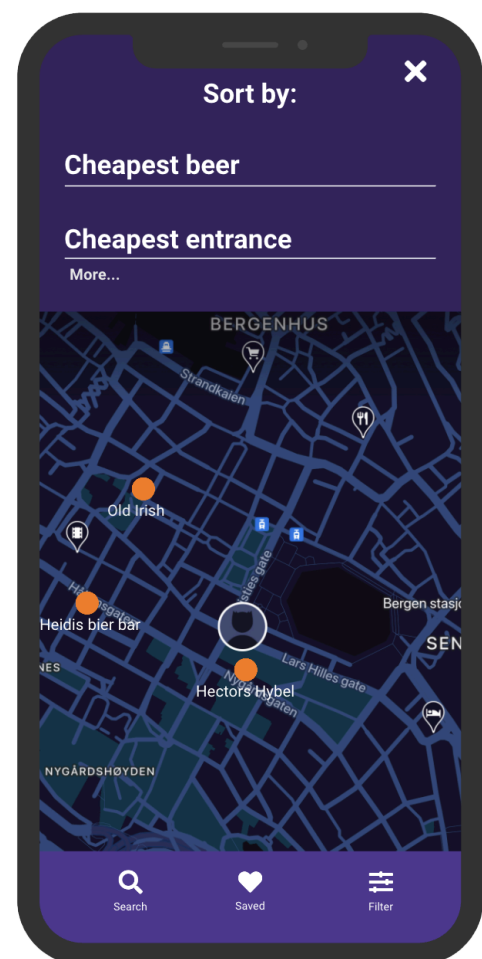
Figure 11



Prototype 8



Prototype 9



The original app provides a basic filter menu with category options such as "Favorites," "Restaurant," "Concert," "Nightclub," "Outdoor," and "Bar." (Figure 11). While functional, the filtering options are limited and do not address the needs of users who prioritize specific features like price or entrance fees. Prototype 8 introduces a new sorting feature, allowing users to organize venues by specific criteria like "Cheapest Beer." The prototype highlights the most affordable option: "Old Irish is cheapest now in town!" with a clear visual marker. We also added a call-to-action button, making it easy for users to get directions directly to the selected venue, as the app already uses Google maps as their map provider.

Prototype 9 expands on the sorting options by including multiple criteria, such as "Cheapest Beer" and "Cheapest Entrance." This allows users to customize their search based on what matters most to them, providing a more user-focused experience. The map view dynamically

updates according to the selected sorting option, helping users quickly locate venues that match their preferences.

9.0 Conclusion

This assignment explored the Nightli app, looking at how easy it is to use, how accessible it is, and the overall experience it gives users. By comparing it to competitors like Untappd, Google Maps, Eventbrite, and Yelp, we found what Nightli does well and where it can improve, especially in making the app more user-friendly and accessible.

Our evaluations, including expert reviews and user testing, helped identify key problems like confusing navigation, inconsistent design, and the app being limited to Sweden. Users also wanted better features, like drink pricing, easier searching, and more detailed reviews. We addressed these issues during the design process, creating prototypes that added helpful features like a “My Page,” improved search tools, and detailed venue menus.

The feedback and testing helped us make big improvements to how easy the app is to use, how quickly users can learn it, and how it looks overall. These changes aim to make Nightli a top choice for students and young adults looking for nightlife events.

In summary, this assignment showed how important it is to focus on user needs when designing and improving an app. With these updates, Nightli is better positioned to grow and offer a more enjoyable and useful experience for its users.

10.0 References:

Eventbrite. (2024, September 23). *Eventbrite website*. <https://www.eventbrite.com>

Figures 1 and 2 below the Nightli description are screenshots taken from the official app. (2024, September 23).

Figures 8, 9, 10 and 11 are screenshots taken from the official Nightli app. (2024, November 3).

Figure 3 contains a screenshot from the Untappd iOS app. (2024, September 24).

Figure 4 contains a screenshot from Google Maps on Android. (2024, September 24).

Figures 5 and 6 are screenshots taken from the Eventbrite app. (2024, September 24).

Figure 7 contains a screenshot from the Yelp app on iOS. (2024, September 24).

Google Maps. (2024, September 24). *Google Maps*. <https://www.google.com/maps>

Nightli app. (2024, September 10). *Nightli app*. <https://app.nightli.se>

Untappd. (2024, September 30). *Untappd app*. <https://untappd.com>

Yelp. (2024, September 23). *Yelp website*. <https://www.yelp.no/oslo>

Preece, J., Rogers, Y., & Sharp, H. (2019). *Interaction design: Beyond human-computer interaction* (5th ed.). John Wiley & Sons, Inc.

Nightli. (2024, November 13). *Nightli website*. <https://app.nightli.se>

Note: Information about pricing options in the prototypes is fictitious and not actual pricing from the venue(s).

Prototype figures 1-9 are our prototype figures made using Miro. (2024). *Miro*. <https://miro.com/app>

